INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, KANPUR
POST GRADUATE OFFICE

No. (P)/SPGC/IITK/2018-19/
May 09, 2019

MINUTES OF THE 5thMEETING OF THE SENATE POSTGRADUATE COMMITTEE (2018-19)

(Date & Time: March 07, 2019Thursday, 4:00 pm; Venue: QIP Conference Room, Academic Affairs Building)

Members Present: Drs S Mariappan, I S Dalal, S Misra, R P Potluri, S Khandekar, S Bhoumic (in place of Dr A Singh), M J Akhtar, S Ananthraman (in place of DrP Sen), S T Roy, S K Pattanaik (in place of Dr S Mitra), D Chakrabarti, G Rajshekhar, A Shukla, R Bhowmik, I S Sen, D Kumar, A Jain, N Kaistha, Mr U Sagar, Ms Somya, Mr Vineeth V

Members Absent: Drs S Ganguly, R Varman, P Munshi and W Ahmad

Item 0 Confirmation of Minutes of the fourth Meeting of SPGC (2018-19) held on December 28, 2018.
The minuteswere confirmed.

Item 1 Ratification of Decisions Taken / Approvals Given by Chairperson, SPGC
The SPGC ratified the following decisions taken / approvals given by Chairperson, SPGC:

Ratification Items

(a) Theses submission deadline extension

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dep/IDP*	*Due Date*	*Extension till*
01	101016075	Saleem Shaik	MSE	10/01/2019	31/01/2019
02	13107067	BidhanHazra	CHM	31/01/2019	30/04/2019
03	Y9102066	Sandeep Kumar	CHE	29/12/2018	29/03/2019
04	14118266	PunitaKumari	BSBE	25/01/2019	25/04/2019
05	12108061	Anuj Kumar More	MTH	18/01/2019	18/02/2019
06	12209873	Naorem Rameshwari	PHY	31/01/2019	31/03/2019
07	13104173	Himangshu Bhusan Baskey	EE	14/02/2019	14/05/2019
08	12207081	Vipin Kumar Jain	CHM	15/01/2019	15/04/2019
09	14108262	ArpitaNayek	MTH	14/02/2019	14/05/2019
10	11209067	Pavan Kumar	PHY	28/02/2019	28/03/2019

(b) SOTA deadline extension

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept /IDP*	*Due Date*	*Extension till*
01	17127263	SoubhagyaSahoo	ECO	23/01/2019	23/04/2019
02	16106272	SumanaMaji	MSE	30/01/2019	30/04/2019
03	17127261	Nilanjan Bhattacharya	ECO	23/01/2019	23/04/2019
04	16204282	Sonam Acharya	EE	09/01/2019	09/04/2019
05	16102269	Lakshmi Kushwaha	CHE	10/01/2019	10/03/2019
06	17105261	Akanksha Gupta	ME	30/11/2018	01/03/2019

(c) Leave granted on personal / medical grounds

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*
01	13101072	Swati Swarnkar	AE	PhD	2018-19-II; joining job. DPGC positive.
02	16103406	Rahul Soni	CE	MSR	2018-19-II; Personal grounds. DPGC positive.
03	16104093	Telma Th. Cyriac	EE	MTech	2018-19-II; joining job. DPGC positive.
04	16103407	S Bhattacharyya	CE	MSR	Leave from 04/02/2019 till end of 2018-19-II; joining JRF position. DPGC positive.
05	15105404	Amritansh Aishwarya	ME	MSR	2018-19-II; Personal grounds. DPGC positive.

(d) Extension of deadline for qualifying comprehensive examination

S No	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*Preset Status*
01	16211264	S Srivastva	CSE	PhD	Ten day extension. DPGC positive	Passed on14/01/2019
02	16118272	S Pandey	BSBE	PhD	One month extension. DPGC positive	Passed on 11/01/2019
03	16102264	D Kishal	CHE	PhD	Three months extension. DPGC positive	Passed on 28/02/2019
04	16102273	P Chaudhary	CHE	PhD	Two months extension. DPGC positive	Passed on 22/02/2019
05	17114261	A Das	IME	PhD	Three weeks extension DPGC positive	Passed on 28/02/2019

Item 2 Reporting Items

The SPGC took note of the following reporting item

Withdrawal from the PG program

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept./IDP*	*Program*
01	16107265	Dipti Lai	CHM	PhD
02	15118271	Pragya Gupta	BSBE	PhD
03	16207284	Swati Singh	CHM	PhD
04	18205269	Shina Choubey	ME	PhD
05	18101047	Yash Panchal	AE	M Tech
06	18104075	Pragati Pathak	EE	M Tech
07	18101042	Sumeet Bhatia	AE	MTech
08	18101008	Anupam Kumar Yadav	AE	M Tech
09	18105073	Ram Niwas Legha	ME	M Tech
10	18105095	Sylesh T A	ME	M Tech
11	18101037	Satyendra Das	AE	M Tech
12	18101031	Rajneesh Kumar Verma	AE	M Tech
13	18112016	Vijay Kumar Saini	MSP	M Tech
14	18105010	Ankit Kumar	ME	M Tech
15	18111029	Kapil Kumar	CSE	M Tech
16	18105020	Asit Sen	ME	M Tech
17	18101016	G R Krishna Chand Avatar	AE	M Tech
18	18105012	Anupam Upadhyay	ME	M Tech
19	18105077	RonakLodha	ME	M Tech
20	17105091	Manish Narayan Trivedi	ME	M Tech
21	16105408	Rama Karan Ashvinkumar	ME	MSR
22	18111407	Nathiraj Jain	CSE	MSR
23	17109272	Subhadip Jana	PHY	PhD
24	18103269	Nilesh Kala	CE	PhD
25	16109864	Venus Rai	PHY	PhD
26	18209270	SudevNamboothiri N M	PHY	PhD
27	18202261	AbhinavPorwal	CHE	PhD
28	18204266	Gouriprasad Bhattacharyya	EE	PhD

Item 3 Routine Items Requiring SPGC Approval

SPGC granted approval to following routine items with noted specific observations (if any)

(a) New course approval

The SPGC approved following new courses

SNo	*Course No*	*Course Title*	*Credits*	*Proposed by*
01	CSE771	Introduction to Machine Learning	3-0-0-0-9	Dr P Kar
02	BSE643	Chemical and Synthetic Biology	3-0-0-0-9	Dr Arun K Shukla
03	BSE642	Microbiology and Immunology	3-0-0-0-9	Drs. S Matheshwaran & Jayandharan G Rao
04	CHE619	Advanced Fluid Mechanics	3-0-0-0-9	Dr N Tiwari

(b) Leave for the semester of 2018-19-II

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Decision*
01	13107080	Younis Ahmad Pandit	CHM	PhD	Leave for 2018-19-II; Third time; Supervisor & DPGC have recommended.	Leave granted for the semester 2018-19-II as a special case.

(c) Extension of deadline for qualifying comprehensive examination

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Decision*

01	16211265	Munender Kumar	CSE	PhD	Up to end of 2018-19-II semester. Supervisor and DPGC have recommended.	SPGC approved the extension of deadline

Item 4 Requiring SPGC Recommendations for Consideration of Chairperson Senate / Senate

(a) Inclusion of co-supervisor outside IIT Kanpur

S No	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Recommendation*
01	15206265	Khushubo Devi	MSE	PhD	Dr B Majumdar, DMRL, Hyderabad	Recommended
02	18106022	T Damodar Naidu	MSE	M Tech	Dr A Banerjee, Tata Steel Ltd., R&D Division, Jamshedpur	Recommended
03	17111269	Prantik Chatterjee	CSE	PhD	Dr A Lal, Senior Researcher, Microsoft Research India	Recommended
04	15511266	Kranti Kumar Parida	CSE	PhD	Dr Gaurav Sharma, Researcher, NEC Labs America, Cupertino, CA, USA	Recommended
05	17111266	Neeraj Matiyali	CSE	PhD	Dr Gaurav Sharma, Researcher, NEC Labs America, Cupertino, CA, USA	Recommended
06	16211264	Siddharth Srivastava	CSE	PhD	Dr Phlippe Dugerdil, Geneva School of Business Administration (HEG), Geneva, Switzerland	Recommended
07	13111162	Garima Gaur	CSE	PhD	Dr Srikanta Bedathur, Dept. of CSE, IIT Delhi	Recommended
08	18123010	Neeraj Nainwal	ES	M Tech	Dr Praveen Kumar, K V Scientist, NGRI, Hyderabad	Recommended
09	15215261	Annesha Karmakar	NET	PhD	Dr Anil Kumar Gourishetty, IIT Roorkee.	Recommended

(b) Exit from the PhD programme with M Tech degree

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Recommendation*
01	15223263	Shivangi Tiwari	ES	PhD	Supervisor and DPGC have recommended.	Satisfies all the requirements for exit option listed in the PG Manual under Section 7.8. Exit with M Tech recommended.

(c) Leave of first year PG student

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Recommendation*
01	18103063	Priyank Pandey	CE	M Tech	Leave for 2018-19-II and Summer Term of 2019. Personal grounds. DPGC and Thesis supervisor's positive recommendations.	Referred back to DPGC, Convener, CE for ascertaining genuineness of request. Chairperson authorized to further necessary action.

(d) Extension of thesis submission deadline beyond nine months of open seminar delivery

S No	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dep/IDP*	*Actual Date*	*Due date of extension*	*beyond 9 months*	*SPGC Recommendation*
01	11115061	S P Saraswat	NET	24//11/2018	24/02/2019	24/05/2019	Not recommended. As there no such provision in the PG Manual. Open seminar to be delivered again

5 Policy matters requiring detailed discussions.

(a) To consider the proposal for admission to PG programs (PhD & M Tech) for employees of IIT Kanpur startups and those associated with the Research Park companies.

The item was deferred for next SPGC meeting.

(b) To consider the proposal for exemption from submission of thesis to the Institute online repository for 'Defence Personnel'.

The SPGC constituted the sub-committee noted below to suggest the way forward.
1. R Potluri EE Convener 2. Sudhir Misra CE Member 3. Samir Khandekar ME Member

The committee shall do the needful and report back to the SPGC in a timely manner.

(c) To consider the proposal of DPGC, Convener, Dept. of Physics, for candidates having qualified JEST (Joint Entrance Screening Test) to be included as an eligibility criterion for PhD admission in Physics department.

The SPGC considered the proposal and recommends that JEST (Joint Entrance Screening Test) qualified candidates be considered as eligible for admission into the PhD program with Institute Assistantship in the Department of Physics.

(d) To consider the proposal of DPGC, Convener, Dept. of Physics, for Direct admission of 2 year M.Sc. Physics students of IITK to PhD programme.

The SPGC considered the proposal and recommends that the proposal for offering provisional admission to MSc 2-year students of IIT Kanpur based on the CPI after 3rd semester. These students fulfil the eligibility criteria under Clause 2.4.6 of the PG manual. The admissions should be offered in winter period before the commencement of our regular admission process in April.

(e) To discuss on feedback received from various departments on 'revising the PhD thesis evaluation procedure'.

Based on feedback received from the various departments and after detailed discussions, the SPGC recommends the final proposal for revising the PhD thesis review procedure is enclosed in Annexure - A.

6 Any other item with the permission of the Chair.

(a) Non registration of M Tech students

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Recommendation*
01	13104006	Abhishek Singh	EE	M Tech	Not taken any leave	Recommends termination
02	17103079	Ravi Roushan	CE	M Tech	-do-	-do-
03	16103056	Prince	CE	M Tech	-do-	-do-
04	16101064	Sanjeev S S	AE	M Tech	-do-	-do-

(b) To consider the proposal of DPGC, Convener, Dept. of Mathematics & Statistics, for candidates having qualified GATE in Statistics examination are eligible to apply for PhD programme.

After due deliberations, the SPGC positively recommends the proposal for approval of the Senate.

(c) To consider the proposal of DPGC, Convener, PSE for modification in the eligibility criteria of MS (By Research) programme. The meeting ended with a vote of thanks to the Chair.

The proposal was not accepted by the SPGC. Hence, existing Clause shall remain.

(Nitin Kaistha)
Chairperson, SPGC

Copy to: 1. All Members of SPGC
2. Chairman, Senate
3. DOAA

REDUCING THE THESIS EXTERNAL REVIEW PROCESS COMPLETION TIME

Background

The reviewed data clearly shows that:

- More than 35% theses take above 4 months for external review completion.
- The average response time of foreign referees is 20+ days less than the Indian referee.
- If only two reviews were required, the average external review completion time will be more than a month lower (79 days for 2 reviews vs 116 days for 3 reviews)

SPGC View

The SPGC is of the firm view that when journals have moved from 3-6 months manuscript review period ~15 years ago, to 3-6 weeks today, it is not healthy for IITK to have a thesis external review average lag time of ~4 months.

Recommendation

With a view to significantly reducing the lag time, the SPGC suggests that:

- An automated online thesis review portal be developed on priority with automated reminders to the reviewers. In the interim, a stop-gap automated arrangement should be put in place.
- Revise the external thesis review process so that in case the first two received reports are positive (not category III), the referee whose report is awaited is given 2 weeks to submit the review (assuming s/he is past the deadline). If the referee still does not respond, the thesis processing need not be further delayed and the thesis defence may proceed armed with the two positive reviews.

The detailed revised step-by-step thesis external review process, after receiving feedback from various departments, is as below:

1. The three referees are approached, as usual. The distinction of abroad vs within India should be done away with. The approached referees should be well reputed in the research area of the thesis.
2. At the time of approaching the referees, they are gently intimated that they may be requested to serve on the PhD thesis oral board with additional remuneration as per norms and that by consenting to review the thesis, they are also expressing their willingness to serve on the oral board. Referees from abroad will also be intimated that their participation in the oral board examination, should they be requested, shall be over video conferencing only.
3. In case the first two referee reports are positive (i.e. not category III) and both reports are from abroad, then the higher priority referee (as per Chairman, Senate's original prioritization) is requested to join the thesis oral examination board. In case one of the reports is from within India, the Indian examiner is requested to serve on the oral board.
4. Concurrently, the remaining third referee is given a final deadline to submit the review. This deadline shall be two weeks from the receipt of the second report or the originally conveyed deadline, whichever is later. The polite

reminder shall clearly specify that the given deadline is final and in case we do not hear from him/her, we shall assume that s/he is not in a position to review the thesis and proceed further with the processing of the thesis.

5. One week before the deadline, a final reminder is sent to the referee whose review is awaited.
6. During the correspondence with the referee, in case the s/he seeks reasonable additional time to send the review (say extra two weeks), the deadline is extended as requested.
7. In case referee does not submit review by the final deadline (including extension if any), a very polite message is sent to him/her saying that while we appreciate the time and energy that may have been spent in reviewing the thesis, in the interest of time, it shall not be possible for us to wait further for his/her review. We hope s/he would be willing to oblige us with a timely review the next time.
8. Armed with two positive (non category III) referee reports and respective student responses and revised thesis, the process for thesis oral defence is initiated by the thesis supervisor.
9. In case the third review is received sufficiently before the thesis oral defence, all efforts shall be made to address the concerns raised. This includes postponing the defence in case the delayed third report is Category III.
10. Honorarium shall be paid to all delayed third reports.